THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 08

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

The great banyan tree in many Indian villages is more than a tree. Its roots drop from the branches and become new trunks, so that one tree can cover the area of a small field. Birds nest in it, cattle rest beneath it and the village elders often hold their meetings in its shade.

Trees give more than shade. They absorb carbon dioxide, release oxygen and cool the air around them. A single tree can hold the soil with its roots so that heavy rain does not wash it away. Forests act like sponges, soaking up rainwater and releasing it slowly into streams.

The banyan also teaches a lesson in sharing. Its dense branches shelter birds, squirrels, bats and insects, while its small red figs feed them through the year. Beneath it, a tea seller sets up his stall, a cobbler spreads his tools and a child sits down to finish her homework in the shade. No one pays rent, and no one is turned away.

Environmentalists therefore call such trees keystones of the village ecosystem. When a banyan is cut for a wider road, the creatures that lived in it leave, the soil around it dries and the shade that cooled the lane disappears. Many villages now declare their old trees protected and tie a sacred thread around the trunk. The thread may be a tradition, but the idea behind it is a modern one: what shelters all deserves the protection of all.

Children love such trees because they invite play: the hanging roots become swings, and the broad trunk becomes a fort. In the evening the same tree turns into a stage for the village, where stories are told and songs are sung and the day's quarrels are forgotten. Perhaps this is why sages in many ages chose to sit under a tree to think. Shade there is not merely protection from the sun but a gentle encouragement to slow down, look about and remember that human beings are only one among many dwellers on earth.

Yet each year we lose large stretches of forest for roads, mines and buildings. Planting a sapling is easy; making it survive is harder. A sapling needs water in summer, a guard against cattle and love for several years. The best way to celebrate a birthday or an anniversary is to plant a tree and promise to look after it. Such a promise, kept for ten years, may be the most useful gift one ever gives.

(i) The banyan tree spreads because its: 1

(a) roots drop from branches and become trunks **(b)** leaves are large

(c) bark is thick **(d)** seeds fly

(ii) Elders hold meetings: 1

(a) in the school **(b)** at the pond

(c) in the shade of the banyan **(d)** at the temple

(iii) Trees help the soil by: 1

(a) holding it with their roots **(b)** making it wet

(c) burning it **(d)** making it rocky

(iv) Forests are compared to: 1

(a) sponges **(b)** walls **(c)** mountains **(d)** rivers

(v) A sapling needs all of these EXCEPT: 1

(a) water in summer **(b)** fertiliser from a factory

(c) protection from cattle **(d)** care for years

(vi) Name two things trees do for the air. 1

(vii) Why are forests being lost? 1

(viii) What does the writer suggest for birthdays? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage meaning 'a young tree'. 1

(x) What makes planting a tree harder than it seems? 1

(xi) Environmentalists call such trees: 1

(a) expensive shade **(b)** keystones of the village ecosystem

(c) dangerous **(d)** unwanted growth

(xii) What happens when an old banyan is cut? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

Dr Meera Joshi, a local doctor, gave a talk to Class 9 students on 'Good Habits for a Healthy Life'. She began by asking how many students had eaten breakfast that morning. Almost a third of the hands stayed down. She explained that skipping breakfast reduces concentration in class and makes children tired by mid-morning. A simple meal of milk, fruit, and a paratha or porridge, she said, gives the brain the energy it needs.

The doctor advised the students to drink at least eight glasses of water a day, to sleep for nine hours and to play outdoors for an hour. She spoke about the dangers of too much screen time, such as eye strain, headaches and poor posture. 'Follow the 20-20-20 rule,' she said. 'After every twenty minutes on a screen, look at an object twenty feet away for twenty seconds.'

At the end, students asked questions. One asked if fast food is bad for health. Dr Joshi smiled and said that it is not a crime to eat it once in a while, but a habit of eating it daily could harm the body. The session ended with a pledge to eat breakfast, drink water and move more.

(i) What did nearly a third of the students not do that morning? 1

(a) Sleep **(b)** Play

(c) Eat breakfast **(d)** Drink water

(ii) How many glasses of water did the doctor advise a day? 1

(a) Four **(b)** Twelve

(c) At least eight **(d)** Two

(iii) The 20-20-20 rule says look at an object twenty feet away for: 1

(a) twenty minutes **(b)** one minute

(c) two seconds **(d)** twenty seconds

(iv) The doctor's view on fast food was that it: 1

(a) is forbidden **(b)** is a healthy meal

(c) should not be a daily habit **(d)** is good for the eyes

(v) What happens when children skip breakfast? 1

(vi) Name two problems caused by too much screen time. 1

(vii) How many hours of sleep did she recommend? 1

(viii) What pledge ended the session? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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